

US00PP35594P3

(12) **United States Plant Patent**
Leis

(10) **Patent No.:** **US PP35,594 P3**
(45) **Date of Patent:** **Jan. 23, 2024**

(54) **STRAWBERRY PLANT NAMED ‘CIVH725’**

(50) Latin Name: *Fragaria x ananassa* Duchesne ex Rozier
Varietal Denomination: **CIVH725**

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(*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this patent is extended or adjusted under 35 U.S.C. 154(b) by 0 days.

(21) Appl. No.: **17/979,717**

(22) Filed: **Nov. 2, 2022**

(65) **Prior Publication Data**

US 2023/0140848 P1 May 4, 2023

(30) **Foreign Application Priority Data**

Nov. 4, 2021 (QZ) PBR 2021/2769

(51) **Int. Cl.**
A01H 5/08 (2018.01)
A01H 6/74 (2018.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./208**

CPC *A01H 6/7409* (2018.05)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**

USPC Plt./208
CPC ... *A01H 5/08; A01H 5/00; A01H 6/74; A01H 6/7409*

See application file for complete search history.

(56) **References Cited**

PUBLICATIONS

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

This invention relates to a new and distinct variety of strawberry plant named ‘CIVH725’. The new june bearing strawberry variety named ‘CIVH725’ is primarily adapted to the climate and growing conditions of Northern areas and is characterized by a rustic plant, tolerant to the most common leaf and root diseases, suitable for tunnel and open field cultivation. The plant has medium-high vigour with semi-upright habit and clearly visible fruit, easy to collect; and the plant is able to have an important second flowering during the season. The new strawberry has a very high productivity, progressive and consistent during all the picking season. The fruits have conical and regular shape with red bright colour, uniform on all the fruit surface; very good resistance to handling and very good shelf-life. The flavour is very good, sweet and slightly aromatic.

4 Drawing Sheets

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Latin name of the genus and species of the plant claimed:
Fragaria x ananassa Duchesne ex Rozier.
Variety denomination: ‘CIVH725’.

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

This application claims priority from Community Plant Variety Rights Application No. 2021/2769, filed Nov. 4, 2021.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct strawberry variety named ‘CIVH725’. The variety is botanically known as *Fragaria x ananassa* Duchesne ex Rozier.

The new strawberry ‘CIVH725’ is a product of a planned breeding program conducted by the inventor, Michelangelo Leis in San Giuseppe di Comacchio, Ferrara, Italy. The objective of the breeding program is to develop june bearing strawberry variety with high chill requirement, suitable both for tunnel and open field cultivation; plant with medium

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vigour and semi-upright habit in order to have clearly fruit easy to collect; fruit with conical, regular shape and bright red colour; skin of the fruits very resistant to handling adapted to long shelf life.

5 This new strawberry ‘CIVH725’ is a result of a controlled cross made by the inventor in 2011, in San Giuseppe di Comacchio, Ferrara, Italy. The male or pollen parent is strawberry selection designated 6C9C-007 (unpatented CIV’s selection). The female or seed parent is strawberry
10 selection designated Z6T2-060 (unpatented CIV’s selection).

The new strawberry ‘CIVH725’ was discovered and selected by the inventor as a single flowering plant within the progeny of the stated cross in May 2013 in San Giuseppe di Comacchio, Ferrara, Italy (44° 45' North and 12° 11' East). After its selection, the new variety was asexually propagated by stolons in a nursery located in San Giuseppe di Comacchio, Ferrara, Italy. The new variety was extensively tested over the next several years in different European area with high chill condition. This propagation has demonstrated that the combination of characteristics as

herein disclosed for the new cultivar are firmly fixed and retained through successive generations of asexual reproduction. The new cultivar reproduces true to type.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

'CIVH725' is primarily adapted to the climate and growing with high chill condition. This area provides the needed and correct temperatures for flower induction, and to produce a strong and vigorous plant, and to maintain fruit quality during full production.

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and are determined to be unique characteristics of 'CIVH725', which in combination distinguish this strawberry plant as a new and distinct variety:

1. Plants with semi-upright habit and medium-high vigour.
2. Adapt for tunnel and open field cultivation.
3. Fruits easy to collect.
4. Fruit with conical and regular shape during all the picking season.
5. Very good resistance to handling.
6. Good shelf life.
7. Very high productivity, progressive and consistent during all the picking season.
8. Important second flowering after the first production peak.

Plants of the new strawberry variety 'CIVH725' differ from plants of the parents, 6C9C-007 and Z6T2-060 in the characteristics described in Table 1.

TABLE 1

Characteristic	'CIVH725'	6C9C-007	Z6T2-060
Time of ripening	Very early to early	Medium	Very early to early
Growth habit	Semi-upright	Upright	Semi-upright
Fruit size	Large	Medium	Large to very large
Firmness	Firm	Medium to high	Medium

Of the many commercial cultivars known to the present inventor, the most similar in comparison to the new strawberry variety 'CIVH725' is the strawberry variety 'APRICA'. Plants of the new strawberry variety 'CIVH725' differ from plants of strawberry variety 'AFRICA' in the characteristics described in Table 2:

TABLE 2

Characteristic	'CIVH725'	'APRICA'
Fruit: time of beginning ripening	Very early to early	Early
Leaf: size	Medium	Large
Flower: diameter	Medium to large	Large to very large

BRIEF DESCRIPTIONS OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying color photographs illustrate the overall appearance of typical specimens of the new strawberry variety 'CIVH725', at various stages of development as true as it is reasonably possible with color reproductions of this type. Color in the photographs may differ slightly from the color value cited in the botanical description which accurately describe the color of 'CIVH725'. The depicted plant

and plant parts of the new strawberry variety 'CIVH725' were taken in San Giuseppe di Comacchio, Ferrara, Italy, and are approximately 6 to 9 months old.

FIG. 1 shows plant of 'CIVH725';

FIG. 2 shows the leaves of 'CIVH725';

FIG. 3 shows typical flowers of 'CIVH725'; and

FIG. 4 shows typical fruits of 'CIVH725'.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

'CIVH725' has not been observed under all possible environmental conditions. The characteristics of the new variety may vary in detail, depending upon variations in environmental factors, including weather (temperature, humidity and light intensity), day length, soil type and location.

The aforementioned photographs, together with the following observations, measurements and values describe the new strawberry variety 'CIVH725', unless otherwise noted, taken during 2022 growing season in San Giuseppe di Comacchio, Ferrara, Italy. The observations, measurements and values were taken from plants of 'CIVH725' dug in December 2020 from CIV' nursery located in 44021 Codigoro, Ferrara, (locality Pomposa), Italy, and planted in July 2021 in CIV' test field in San Giuseppe di Comacchio, Ferrara, Italy.

Plants of the new strawberry variety 'CIVH725' were grown under conditions which closely approximate those generally used in commercial practice.

The observed plants were one year old plants. The plants used in the production field are produced in a nursery in CIV' nursery located in 44021 Codigoro, Ferrara, (locality Pomposa), Italy.

Yield observations and fruit quality characteristics are averaged from 3 year of data collected from the 2020 through 2022 growing seasons. Flower measurements and characteristics are from secondary flowers unless otherwise noted. Fruit characteristics and measurements are from secondary fruit unless otherwise noted.

Color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart (R.H.S.), except where general colors of ordinary significance are used. Color values were taken under daylight conditions approximately in the afternoon in San Giuseppe di Comacchio, Ferrara, Italy. The approximate age of the observed plants is about 12 months.

The following tables 3-9 describe fruit, plant, stolon, foliage, fruiting truss, flower and pest/disease characteristics of the new strawberry 'CIVH725'.

TABLE 3

FRUIT CHARACTERISTICS

Characteristic	'CIVH725'
Color of mature fruit	Red group - RHS 46B
Color of internal flesh	Red group - RHS 45C
Color of internal core	Red group - RHS 43B
Length (cm)	About 4.75 cm
Width (cm)	About 3.1 cm
Ratio length/width	Moderately longer
Calyx diameter (cm)	About 5.3 cm
Average weight (gm)	About 30.5 g
Achene color	Yellow-green group 153B
Number of achenes per cm ² measured at the center of berry	About 9

TABLE 3-continued	
FRUIT CHARACTERISTICS	
Characteristic	‘CIVH725’
Average weight of 1000 achenes (g)	About 0.80 g
Marketable yield (gm/plt)	Average 1.100 gm/plt
Size	Large
Predominant shape	Conical
Difference in shapes between primary and secondary fruit	Slight
Band without achenes	Narrow
Unevenness of surface	Even or slightly uneven
Evenness of color	Even or slightly uneven
Glossiness	Strong
Insertion of achenes	Level with surface
Insertion of calyx	Level with fruit
Attitude of the calyx	Outward
Size of calyx in relation to fruit diameter	Larger
Adherence of calyx	Strong
Firmness of skin	Very firm
Firmness of flesh	Firm
Distribution of red color of the flesh	Uniform
Hollow center expression	Medium
Flavor	Very good flavour, sweet and slightly aromatic
Soluble solids (% brix)	About 8.6%
Time of first and second Flowering	Early. The full bloom of first flowering is at the end of March, and the second flowering is after about 30/40 days from the first flowering in North Italy - Po Valley.
Time of first harvesting	Early
Harvest period	The first harvest period is from the beginning of May to the end of May, and the second harvest period is from the beginning of June to the end of June in North Italy - Po Valley.
Type of bearing	Not remontant

TABLE 4

PLANT CHARACTERISTICS	
Characteristic	‘CIVH725’
Height (cm)	About 27.5 cm
Spread (cm)	About 35 cm
Size	Small to medium
Habit	Semi-upright
Density	Medium
Vigor	Medium to strong

TABLE 5

STOLON CHARACTERISTICS	
Characteristic	‘CIVH725’
Average number per plant	About nr. 10-15
Anthocyanin coloration	Red group - 53B
Anthocyanin intensity	Medium
Diameter at bract (mm)	About 3mm
Pubescence	Medium
Length	About 50 cm

TABLE 6	
FOLIAGE CHARACTERISTICS	
Characteristic	‘CIVH725’
Foliage:	
Color of upper surface	Green group - 137A
Color of underside	Green group - 147B
Shape in cross section	Concave
Interveinal blistering	Absent or weak
Glossiness	Medium
Number of leaflets	3
Terminal Leaflet:	
Length (cm)	About 10.5 cm
Width (cm)	About 8.1 cm
Length/width ratio	Longer
Serrations/leaf	Overlapping
Size	Medium
Shape of base	Obtuse
Shape of teeth	Serrate
Petiole:	
Length (cm)	About 25.5 cm
Diameter (mm)	About 0.5 cm
Pubescence	Strong
Attitude of hairs	Outwards
Stipule:	
Length (mm)	About 4.2 cm
Width (mm)	About 1 cm
Anthocyanin coloration	Strong
Color	Yellow-green group 145C

TABLE 7

FRUITING TRUSS CHARACTERISTICS	
Characteristic	‘CIVH725’
Length (cm)	About 20-25 cm
Attitude	Erect
Position relative to foliage	Slightly below
Pubescence	Weak to medium
Anthocyanin intensity	Absent or very weak
Attitude at first pick	Horizontal
Number of fruit per truss	About from 4 to 6

TABLE 8

FLOWER CHARACTERISTICS	
Characteristic	‘CIVH725’
Petal color	
Mature (upper)	White group - 155D
Mature (lower)	White group - 155D
Petal shape	
Overall	Rounded
Apex	Rounded
Base	Broad
Petal length (mm)	About 1 to 1.2 cm
Petal width (mm)	About 0.9 to 1.1 cm
Petal length/width ratio	Slightly longer
Number of petals/flower	About 5 to 6
Sepals color	
Mature (upper)	Green group - 137A
Mature (lower)	Green group - 138A

TABLE 8-continued

FLOWER CHARACTERISTICS	
Characteristic	‘CIVH725’
Sepal shape	
Overall	Elliptic
Apex	Pointed
Base	Flat
Sepal length (mm)	About 0.9 to 1.1 cm
Sepal width (mm)	About 0.3 to 0.5 cm
Sepal length/width ratio	Longer
Number of sepals/flower	About 9 to 13
Corolla diameter (mm)	About 28 mm
Calyx diameter (mm)	About 31 mm
Size of calyx relative to corolla	Larger
Size of inner calyx relative to outer calyx	Smaller
Relative position of petals	Free to touching
Use: Fresh market.	
Shipping/storage characteristics:	Very good storability and good shelf life.

TABLE 9

REPRODUCTIVE ORGANS	
Characteristic	‘CIVH725’
Receptacle color	Yellow green group - 154B
Pollen color	Yellow orange group - 14A
Stamen	Numerous with pollen present, fertile and abundant.

TABLE 9-continued

REPRODUCTIVE ORGANS	
Characteristic	‘CIVH725’
Stamen length	About 2.4 mm
Stamen color	Yellow-green group - 145C
Pollen amount	Fertile and abundant. Yellow-orange group - 14A
Anthers length	About 1.2 mm
Anthers width	About 0.8 mm
Anthers color	Yellow-orange group - 17C and darkening with advanced maturity.
Pistils	Numerous, generally average in size.

TABLE 10

PEST AND DISEASE REACTIONS	
Characteristic	‘CIVH725’
Powdery mildew (<i>Sphaerotheca macularis</i>)	Tollerant
Angular leaf spot (<i>Xanthomonas fragariae</i>)	Moderately susceptible
Botrytis fruit rot (<i>Botrytis cinerea</i>)	Very low sensibility
Fusarium wilt (<i>Fusarium oxysporum</i>)	Moderately susceptible
Anthracnose crown rot (<i>Colletotrichum fragariae</i>)	Moderately susceptible
Two-spotted spider mite (<i>Tetranychus urticae</i>)	Susceptible

I claim:

1. A new and distinct strawberry plant named ‘CIVH725’, as herein described and illustrated by the characteristics set forth above.

* * * * *

FIG. 1



FIG. 2

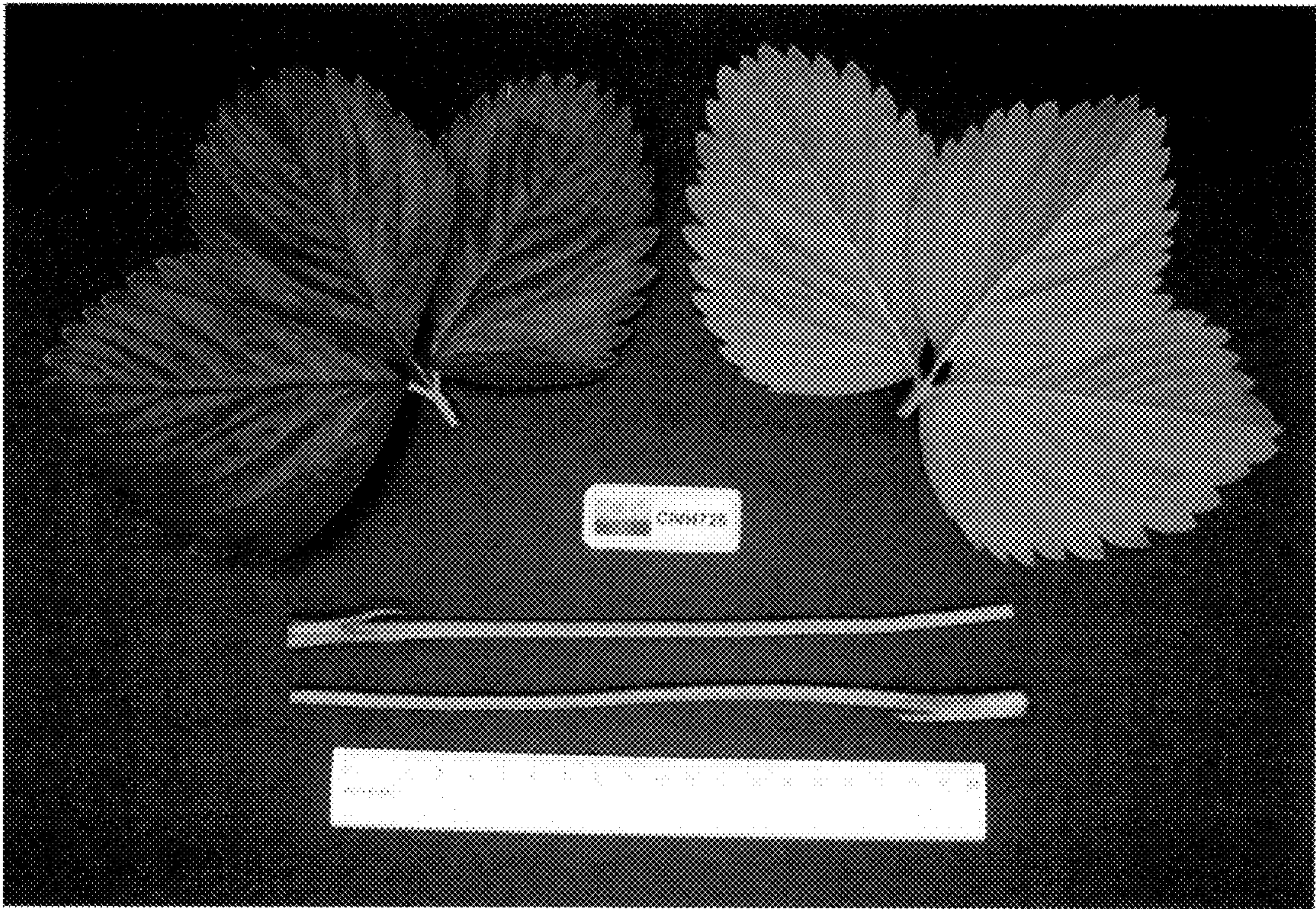


FIG. 3



FIG. 4

